

richest slave society. Plantations in the South generated vast wealth, while the numbers of those enslaved rose, as did their monetary value. New states such as Texas, as well as new lands that had been seized from American Indians drew thousands of white men seeking to make quick profits on virgin soil. Tens of thousands of slaves were separated from their families in the older seaboard states and sold to the new ones in the Southwest. The enslaved population grew from 700,000 in 1790 to four million in 1860.

4 MILLION The number of bales of cotton produced annually in the United States by 1860. Each bale weighed 450lb (204kg).



Voting in a rural community

George Bingham's painting *The County Election 1852* shows the democratic system in operation, as residents come to cast their vote. In the 1800s, voting was a white, male domain.